Giving Opinions, Agreeing and Disagreeing

A good discussion often includes **giving your opinion**. People may **agree with you** and want to talk more together. When people **disagree with you**, you don't have to stop talking. Listen to them to understand their **opinion** and explain why your **opinion** is different.

Giving your opinion	**In my opinion,** people should use public transport more. **I think (that)** schools should provide meals for children. **I don't think (that)** school uniforms are a good idea. **I'm (strongly) in favour of** free healthcare. **I'm (completely) against** homework.
Asking someone's opinion	**What do *you* think?** **What do you think about** the new Italian restaurant? **What's your view on** climate change? **What's your opinion on** the city bus service?
Agreeing with an opinion Continue the conversation with more points!	**You're (absolutely) right.** Using cars causes air pollution. **I (totally) agree.** Kids need at least one healthy meal a day. **I don't think so either.** Fashion is important to children. **Me too.** It's not fair to take money from sick people. **So am I.** School children need more time to play. **Exactly!**
Disagreeing with an opinion Explain or ask more questions!	**Yes, but** a car gives you freedom. **I (completely) disagree.** Parents should provide food. **Actually, I think** uniforms make rich and poor people equal. **Don't you think** paying for healthcare makes people take better care of their health? **I'm not sure about that.** Homework helps kids improve. **I don't think so.**
Being undecided	**I hadn't thought about that.** **I don't really know much about it.** **You may be right.**

Conversation Practice

1. Practice this conversation, where two people **disagree about** school uniforms. Then change the conversation so the people **agree with** each other.

Katherine: I hate my school uniform. I don't think uniforms are a good idea.
Rob: Actually, I think uniforms make rich and poor people equal because everyone looks the same.
Katherine: Yes, but uniforms are ugly!
Rob: I don't think so. Besides, you can get dressed quickly in the morning.
Katherine: True, but I can't express my own fashion sense.
Rob: I'm not sure about that. You can choose what to wear on the weekends.

Katherine: I hate my school uniform. I don't think uniforms are a good idea.

Rob: .....

Katherine: Yes, and uniforms are ugly!

Rob: .....

Katherine: And another thing - I can't express my own fashion sense.

Rob: .....

2. Practice this conversation, where two people **agree about** childcare. Then change the conversation so the people **disagree with** each other.

Jacob: I really think more companies should offer free childcare. What do *you* think?
Isabelle: I completely agree. Childcare is so expensive.
Jacob: Yeah, and difficult to find.
Isabelle: You're right. We had to wait 6 months for a place for our baby's daycare.
Jacob: More women could return to work if there was childcare at their office.
Isabelle: Exactly!

Jacob: I really think more companies should offer free childcare. What do *you* think?

Isabelle: I disagree. .....

Jacob: Yes, but .....

Isabelle: Don't you think .....?

Jacob: Actually, I think .....

Isabelle: Oh, I hadn't thought about that.

Desert Island Challenge

Your group is going to live on a desert island for a year but can only take a small bag. Choose 6 things from the items below to help you survive. Tell your group *why* you want to take some things but not others. Do you **agree** or **disagree** with your group's choices?

a torch / a flashlight	**a knife, fork & spoon**	**a bottle of sun cream**	**a sewing kit**
2kg gummy bears	**a bottle of vodka**	**a tropical plant book**	**a knife**
a mirror	**a box of matches**	**20m strong rope**	**a fishing net**
a first aid kit	**a shovel**	**a large blanket**	**a saucepan**

When **everyone** agrees, write your choices here:

1. ……
2. ……
3. ……
4. ……
5. ……
6. ……

Ask your Class!

Choose a topic from the list below OR think of your own topic. Ask 10 people their **opinion about** it and write the results in a graph below. Start by using one of these phrases to **give your opinion**:

In my opinion,

I think (that)

I don't think (that)

I'm (strongly) in favour of

I'm (completely) against

A. …couples should split the bill on a first date.

B. …more men should take *paternity leave. (*time off work after having a baby)

C. …foreign people should not be allowed to vote.

D. …smoking should be banned.

E. …we should stop having single-sex schools (all boys or all girls).

F. …celebrities earn too much money.

What do *you* think?

Keep count here:

Agree **Disagree** **Undecided**